

Design & Technology Technician

The Design & Technology Technician plays an essential role in supporting the dynamic and innovative learning environment within the Engineering, Design Technology, and Food curriculum areas. This position is vital for ensuring the seamless operation of practical lessons, the well-being of students and staff, and the maintenance of high standards across all workshop and classroom spaces. You will be a proactive and indispensable presence, contributing significantly to an engaging and effective learning experience for all pupils as they explore their creativity and technical skills within a structured and safe setting.

Core Purpose

The core purpose of the Design & Technology Technician is to provide comprehensive technical support to teaching staff, fostering a secure, organised, and positive atmosphere for practical learning. This involves meticulously preparing equipment and resources for lessons, ensuring the efficient maintenance of tools and machinery, and actively upholding health and safety standards. By maintaining an optimal learning environment and offering crucial support and guidance, the Design & Technology Technician contributes directly to the safety, well-being, and positive experience of every student, enabling them to engage fully with the curriculum and develop their practical skills effectively.

Key Areas of Responsibility

1. Technical Support and Preparation

- Prepare equipment and resources thoroughly before lessons, ensuring all materials are readily available and in optimal condition.
- Organise and manage the efficient movement of equipment and materials for various lessons, promoting smooth transitions and effective use of time.
- Ensure curriculum area resources are meticulously catalogued and stored correctly, facilitating easy access and inventory management.
- Assist staff in the development of appropriate and engaging resources for teaching and learning, contributing to a rich educational experience.
- Provide invaluable support for teaching staff during practical lessons, ensuring a safe and productive environment for all students.
- Deliver clear and concise demonstrations to students in conjunction with teaching staff, particularly in specialist areas, to enhance understanding and skill development.
- Work collaboratively with individual students, offering guidance and support as they undertake research and practical projects.

- Supervise and support Post 16 students effectively as they undertake independent practical work, fostering their autonomy and skill development.

2. Safety, Maintenance, and Environment

- Maintain a safe and secure environment for all students and staff within the Engineering, Design Technology, and Food curriculum areas, proactively identifying and mitigating potential risks.
- Under the direction of Directors of Learning, ensure that all health and safety requirements are met and consistently followed, including undertaking relevant risk assessments for classrooms, processes, and machinery.
- Regularly maintain and repair equipment and tools within the workshop and classroom areas, ensuring their longevity and safe operation.
- Empty and clean dust extraction filters as required by the manufacturer, maintaining air quality and safety standards.
- Ensure all classrooms are kept organised, tidy, and free from hazards, promoting a conducive learning environment.
- Check large machinery regularly and conduct regular local exhaust ventilation (LEV) tests to ensure compliance and safety.
- Maintain a learning environment in which students and staff can work effectively, fostering focus and productivity.

3. General Duties and Professional Practice

- Assist with other duties as directed by senior staff and Directors of Learning, demonstrating flexibility and a willingness to support the wider academy team.
- Act as a positive role model through personal and professional conduct, upholding the academy's values and ethos.
- Work collaboratively as a valued member of the curriculum area team, contributing positively to effective working relations and mutual support.
- Contribute to the effective running of the academy, particularly within the Design & Technology departments, during the school day.
- Assist with exhibitions, displays, and moderation of student work, showcasing achievements and promoting the subjects.
- Provide support for teaching staff in promoting and raising the profile of Engineering, Design Technology, and Food within and outside the school.
- Commit to the ongoing development of the STEM curriculum within the school, embracing new initiatives and technologies.
- Ensure displays are current and of the highest standard, effectively showcasing students' work, project work, and artefacts.
- Transfer students' work to digital media as required, demonstrating proficiency in relevant software.
- Organise and investigate the use of new technologies to support and enhance teaching and learning within the curriculum areas.
- Train, help, advise, and provide comprehensive support to staff and students on the appropriate and safe use of equipment and materials.
- Actively participate in the performance development process and engage in training and professional development activities as required.
- Promote equal opportunities and celebrate diversity in all aspects of the school, fostering an inclusive environment.
- Adhere to the school's Dress Code and comply with all school and Trust policies and procedures, including those relating to conduct, confidentiality, and data protection.

Person Specification – Design and Technology Technician

This section outlines the essential and desirable attributes for the DT Technician role:

Qualifications and Training

Essential:

- Educated to GCSE level standard or equivalent (English and Maths A*–C grade or equivalent).

Desirable:

- Accreditation of Design and Technology Health and Safety Training standards, or a willingness to be trained in these standards.
- Certified First Aid Trained (training will be provided if not already held).

Knowledge and Understanding

Essential:

- Fundamental understanding of safeguarding principles and their application in an educational setting.
- Clear understanding of duty of care responsibilities towards children and young people.
- Familiarity with health and safety regulations relevant to workshop environments and practical subjects.

Desirable:

- Knowledge of various materials, tools, and machinery used in Design & Technology, Engineering, and Food technology.
- Awareness of common technical issues and troubleshooting techniques related to workshop equipment.
- Understanding of effective organisational strategies for practical learning spaces.

Experience

Essential:

- Experience in maintaining order and promoting safe practices in a practical setting.
- Experience in a role requiring responsibility and reliability.

Desirable:

- Practical, hands-on experience in a workshop or technical environment.
- Experience in providing technical support to others.
- Experience working in a school or educational environment.
- Experience with risk assessments related to practical activities.

Skills and Abilities

Essential:

- Good communication skills, enabling clear and effective interaction with students and staff.
- Ability to work constructively and collaboratively as part of a team, contributing effectively to shared goals.
- Strong organisational skills, with the ability to manage resources and prioritise tasks effectively.
- Capacity to follow instructions and implement academy policies consistently.
- Ability to show initiative and proactively identify and address potential issues before they escalate.
- Confident in the use of ICT to support various tasks.
- Ability to learn new skills and adapt to evolving technical requirements.

Desirable:

- Ability to problem-solve and troubleshoot technical issues independently.
- Ability to train, advise, and support others in the use of equipment.
- A proactive and adaptable approach to challenges.
- Strong attention to detail in maintaining equipment and spaces.

Personal Qualities

The Design & Technology Technician will be a **highly organised and proactive individual** with a **keen eye for detail**. They will possess a **natural aptitude for practical tasks** and a **genuine enthusiasm** for supporting technical education. This role requires someone who is not only **reliable and responsible** but also **possesses a calm and methodical approach** to managing equipment and maintaining safety standards. An **effective communicator**, they will be able to **clearly convey technical information** and **offer helpful guidance** to both students and staff. Crucially, they will be a **dedicated team player**, committed to fostering an **engaging and efficient learning environment** where students can confidently explore and develop their design and technological skills.



Safeguarding of Students and Duty of Care

All staff, regardless of role, level of seniority and location, have a responsibility to ensure the highest levels of safeguarding and promoting the welfare of our pupils, and we expect all our staff and volunteers to share this commitment. We must collectively create an environment where children feel safe to learn, play, and grow. Children should feel comfortable in their surroundings and know that they can approach any responsible adult with any problems or concerns.

All staff must be able to identify any children who are at risk of harm, and know the characteristics of abuse or neglect. If you suspect or confirm harm then it's essential you know what actions to take.

Annual safeguarding training is offered to all staff at Leigh Academies Trust, and it is the staff member's responsibility to be aware of the most up to date guidance documented in the [Keeping Children Safe in Education document](#) (Department of Education).

Notes

The job description allocates duties and responsibilities but does not direct the particular amount of time to be spent on carrying them out and no part of it may be so construed. This job description is not necessarily a comprehensive definition of the post. It will be reviewed at least once a year and may be subject to modification or amendment at any time after consultation with the holder of the post.

The duties may be varied to meet the changing demands of the academy/business unit at the reasonable discretion of the Principal/Director. This job description does not form part of the contract of employment. It describes the way the post-holder is expected and required to perform and complete the particular duties as set out in the foregoing.